

Child Safeguarding Policy

POLICY TEMPLATE DOCUMENT

1 PURPOSE

To ensure all children in our care are protected from harm, abuse, and neglect. This policy outlines procedures for recognising and reporting child protection concerns.

2 SCOPE

Applies to all staff, volunteers, contractors, and any person working on behalf of the organisation who may come into contact with children.

3 POLICY STATEMENT

We are committed to safeguarding all children in our service and believe every child has the right to live free from abuse, exploitation, and harm.

4 DEFINITIONS

CHILD	A person under the age of 18
ABUSE	Can be physical, emotional, sexual, or neglect
DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON (DLP)	Staff member appointed to receive and act on child protection concerns

5 ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

ALL STAFF:

- ▶ Must report concerns immediately to the DLP
- ▶ Must complete mandatory child protection training

DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON (DLP):

- ▶ Maintains records of all concerns
- ▶ Liaises with Tusla and An Garda Síochána
- ▶ Ensures follow-up and protection measures are in place

6 RECOGNISING ABUSE

Signs include:

- ▶ Unexplained injuries or bruises
- ▶ Sudden changes in behaviour or appearance
- ▶ Reluctance to go home or be with specific adults
- ▶ Poor hygiene or signs of neglect

7 REPORTING PROCEDURE

STEP 1 Staff member observes or is told about a concern.

STEP 2 Record the concern on the Standard Report Form.

STEP 3 Notify the DLP immediately.

STEP 4 DLP assesses and reports to Tusla if necessary.

 Emergency: Contact Gardaí directly.

8 CONFIDENTIALITY

All concerns are handled sensitively and confidentially. Information is shared only on a need-to-know basis in accordance with legislation.

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9 RECRUITMENT AND VETTING

All staff must undergo:

- ▶ Garda Vetting
- ▶ Reference checks (minimum of two)
- ▶ Verification of qualifications

10 TRAINING

All staff must complete:

- ▶ Introduction to Children First e-learning
- ▶ Regular refresher training every 2 years

11 RECORD KEEPING

All concerns, disclosures, and actions taken must be documented and stored securely for 7 years, accessible only to DLP and management.

12 REVIEW

This policy is reviewed annually or after any serious child protection incident.

DATE OF LAST REVIEW

NEXT REVIEW DUE

Tusla — Child and Family Agency: If you have concerns about the safety or welfare of a child, contact Tusla. Tel: 01 771 8500 | Web: www.tusla.ie

An Garda Síochána: In an emergency, contact your local Garda station or call 999 / 112.